

UROMI JDCPI
CORPORATE FACT SHEET

Name	Uromi Justice Development Peace & Caritas Initiatives
Owner	Catholic Diocese of Uromi, Nigeria
Legal Holder	His Lordship, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Aihmiosion Ogun (OSA)
Authorized Representative & Director	Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Oriabure Arhedo
Corporate Registration No:	CAC/IT/No: 50042 & ED/MWASD/NGOR/200/04
Status	Catholic Non-Governmental, Non-Profit making, humanitarian and development organization
Motto	Hope and empowerment for the oppressed
Areas of operation	Integral Development, Human Rights, Democracy and Good Governance, Alternative Dispute Resolution, Peace Building, Micro-Credit and Caritas, TB, HIV/AIDS care and Counseling
Project steered	Conflict Management, Training of Electorate, Election Observation, Budget Monitoring, Community TB Care, HIV/AIDS Awareness Creation & Counseling, Micro-Credit Facilities, Rural Community Development Enlightenment Campaign, Prisoners' Welfare Services, Gender And Child Rights, Widowhood Association, Human Rights, Training Programmes for Police Officers and Youths, Women Development & Promotion, Legal Aid and VC Programming
Focus Group	The rural populace, the economically deprived families, children, students, youths, women and widows living among the poorest of the poor in the society. Inmates in Prison and Ex-inmates and those stigmatized with deadly diseases
Corporate Office	Uromi JDPCI, Catholic Chancery Egbele Quarter, Uromi, Edo State
Physical Address	Inside Uromi Diocesan Chancery at Egbele Quarter, Uromi, Edo State
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Auditors	1. Grant Thornton. CHARTERED Accountants, Benin Branch 2. Edforte, Fortne, Ehiagwina & Associates 141 Benin-Auchi Road Ekpoma, Edo State
Bankers	• UBA BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • ECOBANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • FIDELITY BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • UNITY BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • UNION BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi
Staff Strength	12
Registered Volunteers	55
Project Executed	14

INTRODUCTION

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives (Uromi JDPCI) sustained her engagement for good governance with the strengthening of the capacities of civic group members across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District to effectively engage their representatives for community growth and development. This was done through quarterly meetings which were held in the month of September, 2018 in all of the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District. The meeting provided opportunity for shared learning and experience sharing among the various civic groups in each of the Local Government Areas. The emphasis in this quarter was on strengthening and developing of improvement plans for the sustainability of the civic group intervention across the target communities.

In the course of the meeting the Director Uromi JDPCI gave opening remark in all the Local Government Areas. In his remark he thanked the civic group members for their sustained zeal and commitment since the commencement of the project and then implored them to continue with the same zeal even at the end of the project. He noted that what has been achieved was impressive but would require commitment and dedication to sustain them. He encouraged the groups to be active participants in political activities in their communities as passiveness would not yield the desired results in community development and political engagement. He further urged them to involve the traditional and community leaders in all their engagements.

Uromi JDPCI concluded her SMILE intervention in Esan North East Local Government Area with lofty benefit to the households. Some households got cash transfer while some others got improved tree crops, all in an effort to improve their overall well being.

Concerted effort was also made to increase sensitization and campaign against human trafficking in Esan Land through sensitization visits to churches, schools, mosque, motor park and market. Some households were also assessed for empowerment with a bid to reduce their susceptibility to human trafficking.

The micro credit department kept the vision of enterprise development alive through support to farmers and petty traders with verifiable enterprise.

The prison apostolate desk took the health of the inmates as a priority in this quarter. This was done through health education and HCT.

REPORT OF CIVIC GROUP QUARTERLY MEETINGS HELD ACROSS THE FIVE LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS IN EDO CENTRAL SENATORIAL DISTRICT

The month of September being the end of the 11th quarter since the commencement of the second phase of the project on community mobilization and capacity strengthening for good governance in Edo Central Senatorial District, Uromi JDPCI in collaboration with the 35 civic groups held

quarterly meetings across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District. The meetings served as learning sessions where members of the various civic groups share their experiences, knowledge, challenges and learning from the implementation of activities in their various communities. The quarterly meetings were held at the Palace of traditional leaders in the various Local Government Areas except in Esan Central where it was held in St. Anselm Children Hall because the hall designated by the Monarch in Irrua is still under reconstruction.

The emphasis at the meetings in this quarter was planning to sustain the civic group activities in the various communities across the across the five LGAs in Edo Central Senatorial District and development of plans to participate actively in the forth coming general election.

ESAN CENTRAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

The meeting which was held at St Anselm Children Hall began at 2:30pm with opening prayer which was followed by registration of participants. After which the members were reminded of the need to strengthening their various groups in preparation for project close-out as their commitment was required to sustain the efforts and the progress that have been made in the various communities. Michael Iyoriobhe also asked the groups to share their sustainability plan as well as their plans to participate in the forth coming general election. He thanked the representatives of civic group members present for coming and enjoined them to keep up the good work they were doing in their respective communities. A total of 6 communities were represented at the meeting

REPORTS FROM CIVIC GROUPS ACTIVITIES:

Akho/Eguare Civic Group reported that they went to interact with BEDC officials to repair the bad transformer in their community and that the Customer Service Officer said he has communicated their complaint to the head office and when he gets response he will communicate it to the people. They also reported that they met with the councillor representing their ward to bring to the notice of the Local Government chairman that the markets was dirty as such they should engage workers to clean it. As for sustainability plans, the civic group still intends to hold their meetings and take on issues as they arise in the community

Agwa Civic Group reported that they met with the elders on the needs to invite the councilors for political engagement and follow up on issues presented to the Chairman and that the elders were working on the plan. The facilitator added that the Primary Health Centre was under repairs and that the staff have put up new attitude of commitment, with new leadership in



A civic group member giving report at the quarterly meeting



Michael Iyoriobhe addressing the gathering

place.

USENU Civic Group reported that their transformer was vandalized and that the armoured cable was stolen but Benin Electricity Distribution Company (BEDC) has told them to bear the responsibility for the replacement of the cable. They as a community have approached the Local Government Chairman for assistance and the Chairman conveyed a meeting with the BEDC authority and they communities affected to get a way forward. They were however advised to know that it was not their duty to fund their repair of the vandalized transformer. They said their action was to ameliorate their suffering knowing that BEDC would not repair it if left for them.

EWU Civic Group: reported that the families that were affected by rain storm earlier this year have been assisted by the LGA Chairman with some relief and building materials. He noted that though the items were not enough the community elder appreciated it and have sent for the civic group supervisor to advised on further action.

The Director also promised to approach the Chairman for more support to the victims.

IDUMEBO Civic Group reported that the person who was reported to be giving free water to members of the community in the last quarterly meeting suddenly stopped. When enquiries were made by the civic group members in conjunction with elders in the community, it was discovered that the borehole was broke down but the owner

has promised to fix it and resume giving the water for free.

The Uromi JDPCI Director, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis

Oriabure Arhedo thanked representatives of the entire group for coming to the meeting and reports given so far. He expressed his pleasure on the work done by the all and urged them to work on sustaining their engagement with traditional institutions in the course of their work. He admonished all civic groups to seek ways to sustain the project as it winds down and prepare themselves to participate actively in the forth coming elections. Very Rev. Fr. Fidelis also instructed the civic groups to show deep rooted interest in projects going on in their localit

ESAN WEST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

The meeting which was held at the Palace of the Monarch of Ekpoma Kingdom started at 4:24pm with opening prayer which was followed by registration of participants. After which the members were reminded of the need to strengthening their various groups in preparation for project close-out as their commitment was required to sustain the efforts and the progress that have been made in the various communities. Michael Iyoriobhe also asked the groups to share their sustainability plan as well as their plans to participate in the forth coming general election. He thanked the representatives of civic group members present for coming and enjoined them to



A group photograph of the Director and participants at the meeting

keep up the good work they were doing in their respective communities. A total of 8 communities were represented at the meeting.

REPORTS FROM CIVIC GROUPS ACTIVITIES

EGORO Civic Group: The facilitator William Okhuleigbe reported that the group with the elders in the community on the issue of non-indigenes posing security risks to the community. He explained that the elders had suggested that the foreigners submit passport photographs to the elder's council while the civic group suggested an addition that the landlords of the non-indigenes should stand as sureties for them. He added that they conducted voters' education in their community as well as mobilized their people to register to vote in the forth coming election. They also facilitated the support of their community to secure the transformer in their community from vandalism. He assured members that the group will always hold their meetings and will be ready to engage members of their community in the forth coming elections and even beyond the project life span.



Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo
addressing the gathering

Mr. Michael Iyoriobhe thanked the group for been proactive especially in the area of mobilizing citizens in their community in the CVR exercise. He suggested to them to extend the sensitization to include education voters against selling their votes as well as put modalities in place to prevent vote buying in the community.

Emiala Civic Group: reported that they were working on reaching the local government chairman to repair their primary school which was in dire need of repair and that deliberations were on going to tackle the dilapidated school structure. They were advised to seek the assistance of the Monarch and the councillors in their community so as to draw the required attention to their request.

Emaudo Civic Group: reported that the principals of their school invited them to assist in stamping out cultism in the school. The community have been able to eliminate such acts from the community. He added that the vigilante group has be inaugurated in their community meaning that the existing group has been mainstreamed into the new group and since then the incidence of reported crime has drastically reduce in the community. The facilitator introduced Christian Esekhaegbe as the new facilitator for the group to replace him



A civic group member giving report at
the quarterly meeting

The Director, Uromi JDPCI, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo thanked the out-going facilitator for his zeal and commitment and urged other members of the group to support the new facilitator.

Irukepken Civic Group: The facilitator of the civic group reported that as part of effort to tackle the issue of non-availability of workers in the PHC, they were drafting a letter to be sent to the Hospital Management Board to draw their attention to the situation and request for adequate staffing of the General Hospital.

The group was advised to create a space in the letter where prominent persons and community leaders can endorse it.

Ukhun Civic Group reported that they met with their monarch to discuss the possibility of repairing their road by cleaning, bulldozing and sand filling the bad spots in the roads. They also met with the elders of the community who in-turn instructed the youths to clear bushes on sharp corners so that it will be better visible for motorists plying roads in the community and to prevent kidnappers from using the area as hideouts to conduct their nefarious activities. The vigilante group in the community apprehended two persons who were wondering aimlessly in the community and handed them over to the police. They appreciated for involving the traditional institution in their work.

Ujoelen Civic Group reported that they have influenced the community to construct speed breakers in the roads in their community to avoid over speeding and students related accidents. He added that they have resolved the grievances among the youth and that they now participate actively in community activities, beginning with the clearing of footpaths in the community. He further said that through their effort the community foiled the attempted theft of electrical transformer that supplies electricity to the community and that they have further secured the cables with the use of cement to do a concrete work on it.

Ukpenu Civic Group: The facilitator Chief Omonua reported that the community has adopted their community secretary as the scribe of the civic group. He added that they influenced the community to provide support to secure the electricity transformer in the community to prevent it from being vandalized.

Eguare Civic Group reported that they intervened to stop the commissioning of uncompleted road in Ekpoma. He also stated that they influenced the construction speed breakers on the newly constructed road to avoid road accident. The Civic Group also assisted by involving the Local Government Council to clear trucks that were parked indiscriminately on the road which was causing traffic



A group photograph of the Director and participants at the meeting

Uromi JDPCI Director, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo thanked representatives of the entire group for coming to the meeting and reports given. He admonished all the civic groups to seek ways of sustaining their activities beyond the life span of the project. He also urged them to get ready for voter's education and election activities for the forth coming elections.

Concerns were raised on the state of the newly constructed Ebhoakhua-Iruekpen road and the dangers posed by heavy duty trucks on the road. After some deliberations it was agreed that all civic group members will contribute and support the process to construct height restriction bars to prevent heavy duty trucks from passing the road. Member also resolved visits the Monarch and the Local Government chairman to support the process as well.

ESAN NORTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

The quarterly meeting of Esan North East Local Government civic group which was held on 20th September, 2018 at Onojie's palace, Uromi started at about 12:00 noon with opening prayer and remark. The Program Manager welcomed all members to the meeting and thanked them for what was achieved as well as advised them to set strategies for continuity of the civic group in their various communities.



A group photograph of the Director and participants at the meeting in Esan North East

The Director Very Rev. Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo re-emphasized the essence of capacity building for the civic group which was to enable them stand on their own to continue the civic engagement after the end of the project. He again enlightened the people on the need to resist the act of vote buying while encouraging the civic group members to sensitize their people to actively participate in voting for their preferred candidates during election. Very Rev. Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo encouraged all the civic groups members to be active participants in the electoral process of choosing the right person to govern or lead them at all levels. The meeting was attended by members of five civic groups

REPORTS FROM VARIOUS CIVIC GROUPS

Error Civic Group: The facilitator reported that a team came from the State Government to access the situation of their school with the hope of starting the renovation of the school. He added that they also



The Scribe of Egbele Civic Group giving report during meeting

visited the LGA Chairman and has promised to work (grade) on their road after the raining season. They were advised to get the contact of the team so as to be able to follow up on the plans

Egbele Civic Group The Facilitator reported that during their last meeting the group discussed on Afuda Primary school and awareness campaign on trafficking and illegal migration. The group resolved send three man that three man delegates to see their ward councillor and the Chairman for follow up on the promises made to the community. The councillor was not around but they met another indigene of the community who advised them to exercise patience because work will soon commence on Afuda Primary school. He also said that they did sensitization about trafficking and irregular migration in their community

Efandion Civic Group: Reported that they were working with the community elder to provide desk for their children. The facilitator added that the civic group also conducted sensitization on the dangers of human trafficking in their community.

Ivue Civic Group reported that they have written through the head teacher to the Ministry of Education to get more teachers to Ivue primary school and that the Ministry has sent a team to assess the situation and have promised to send some teachers to the school. They also visited a construction company hosted in their community to assist with the grading of street in their community as part of their social responsibility.



Cross section of members during meeting

The facilitator added that they mobilized their people who were of age to register for their permanent voter's card so as to be eligible to vote in the forth coming election.

Amendokhian Civic Group reported that their primary school (Idigun Primary School) was in disrepair as such they have written series of letter to the Local Government Chairman who referred it to the State Government for necessary action. The Governor through one of their illustrious son has promised to give consideration but that he needed sometime to sought some issues out. He added that voter's education and sensitization was on going with the aim of mobilization the people to vote during the forthcoming election.

ESAN SOUTH EAST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA QUATERLY MEETING

The civic group quarterly meeting in Esan South East Local Government Area was held at the palace of the Onojie of Ubiaja on the 20th of September, 2018. It started at about 3.40pm with prayers and registration which was followed by opening remark and appreciation to the members of the civic group for their support and commitment to community work



Group Photograph with participants after quarterly meeting

in the Local Government Area. The Director among other things encouraged them to resist the act of vote buying in their communities and to mobilize the people for active participation in the election process.

REPORTS FROM CIVIC GROUPS

Ubiaja Civic Group: The Facilitator reported that the Erosion control work which they brought to the Chairman's notice has commenced and the cleaning of the market was also in progress.

Okhuesan Civic Group reported the death of their facilitator and introduced Mr Joel as the new facilitator. They then stated that the European Union has completed the health center they were building for the community. They thanked Uromi JDPCI for the technical support and guidance all through the period.

The facilitator added that the controversial borehole has been reactivated, with a new generator installed to make water available for the community members



The Director addressing the civic group members during quarterly meeting

Emu Civic Group reported that they enquired about the situation of the award of the gully erosion site in their community but they have been told that the contractor will come to site after the rainy season. They added that another road in their community was being considered for construction by NDDC. The facilitator also said that a borehole has been provided for the by Hon. Sergius Ogun, member representing them in the National House of Representatives.

Ewatto Civic Group reported that BEDC has still not restore electricity to their community but that there was sustained negotiation. He added that some projects sponsored by individuals and groups such as the Loyola University were on-going but at a slow pace.

Ewohimi Civic Group reported that the palace road that they appealed for was currently under construction. A part

of electricity bill has been paid, though power has not been restored, further stated that member of the community in diaspora provided students desk for one of the primaries schools to support learning.



The program Manager moderating at the quarterly meeting

Very Rev Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo thanked them for their efforts to harness resources within and outside the community to transform the community.

IGUEBEN Local GOVERNMENT AREA QUATERLY MEETING

The quarterly meeting of Igueben Local Government Area civic groups which was held at the palace of the Onojie of Igueben started at about 3.30pm with prayers and remark taken. The Program Manager commended members for their turnout at the meeting and encouraged them to sustain the effort for more progressive outcomes in their various communities. He urged all to plan and work towards the sustainability of the civic group in the communities especially now that the project was coming to an end. He again tasked them to be actively involved in the forth coming election and that every group should determine the role they want to play as contribution towards having a free and fair election in the year 2019. They were reminded of the need to sensitize their communities in preparation for the election.



Some participants in a group photograph after the meeting

REPORTS FROM CIVIC GROUPS

Idumeka Civic Group: The facilitator reported that one of the Health workers in the general hospital who was perpetuation trouble and dispute among workers in the hospital has been travelled following the petition written to the appropriate authority by the civic group.



A member given report during meeting

Ebelle Civic Group: reported that the construction of the Ebelle market has started. The vigilante has been strengthen with the inclusion of more member and support from Local Government while they were still waiting for dry season to commerce the construction/grading of new street and road in Ebelle

AMAHOR Civic Group reported that the discussion about the construction of the road leading to their community was still on-going as promises from successive government has yielding any result.

Ekpon Civic Group:- reported that they have written a letter to be sent to the Governor to draw his attention to the secondary school that requires renovation and thr roads that needs to be constructed in the community. It further stated that the Monarch has endorsed the letter and has also promised to give financial support to deliver the letter at the Government House in the State Capital.



The Program Manager addressing the civic group members

Eguare/Igueben Civic Group:- The facilitator reported that they have visited the Local Government Chairman who promise to construct a market for them and they have plans to go back and remind him of his promise.

ANTI HUMAN TRAFFICKING

PROTECTION OF MIGRANTS AND ASYLUM SEEKERS ESPECIALLY CHILDREN AND WOMEN COMING FROM NIGERIA AND VICTIMS OF TRAFFICKING (PACKING)

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives in a bid to expand her frontiers in rendering assistance to vulnerable households to retain their children in school collaborated with Girls Power Initiatives (GPI) with support from ECPAT- FRANCE in a project titled “Protection of migrants and asylum seekers especially Children and Women coming from Nigeria and Victims of Trafficking (PACKING)” conducted household assessment, orientation on business planning and empowerment.

ASSESSMENT OF HOUSHOLDS

As a follow up to the school assessment conducted for students in 71 schools in Edo Central Senatorial District, Uromi JDPCI again conducted the final set of assessment for 130 households selected from across communities in the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District. The 130 beneficiaries were selected using the National OVC Management Information System (NOMIS) to analyse the vulnerability status of the various students



A staff conducting Uromi JDPCI conducting assessment in a household

assessed in the project. In the month of July Uromi JDPCI went round the schools and communities to assess the 130 most vulnerable households

using Household Vulnerability Assessment tools (HHVA) with a bid to further narrow down the figure to 50 most vulnerable beneficiaries. At the end of the exercise, 10 households were selected in each of the Local Government Area for empowerment.



A staff conducting Uromi JDPCI conducting assessment in a household

ORIENTATION AND BUSINESS PLANING MEETING WITH BENEFICIARIES

in the month of September, 2018 Uromi JDPCI organized sensitization on business planning and management for selected beneficiaries in the project. The exercise which was conducted for two days (20th and 25th of September, 2018) started with assessment of business plans and available

skills with the caregivers, this was followed with identification and orientation on Income Generating Activities that are peculiar to the locations of the beneficiaries. The exercise later progressed into value chain analysis and then sensitization on the importance of value addition to choice of economic activities identified by the various caregivers. The beneficiaries were later told to go and reflect on the orientation exercise and then come up with a plan for their preferred choice of plan. It was again emphasized that the essence of the economic empowerment was to be able to support the selected children in education, so as to promote retention and progression of the girl child in school, by mentoring them to appreciate the value of education and also use the opportunity to sensitize the students and their households on issues of human trafficking. The first most vulnerable 25 households (5 from each LGA) have been trained on income generating activities (IGA) selection, business planning and management as well as value addition and were empowered with the sum of fifty thousand naira each. The training for the remaining beneficiaries is scheduled for October, and November, 2018



Orientation meeting for empowerment

CAMPAIGN ON ANTI-HUMAN TRAFFICKING AND SAFE MIGRATION (CAT-SaM)

In the same vein, Uromi JDPCI in collaboration with Catholic Caritas Foundation of Nigeria intensified efforts to campaign against human trafficking and irregular migration in Esan North East Local Government area of Edo State, Nigeria. This sensitization was targeted at six communities, Schools, Churches, Mosque, Market and Motor Park in Esan North East Local Government Area.

SENSITIZATION IN SIX COMMUNITIES

The exercise was carried out in the various communities and institutions using audio visual methods (film show). The communities visited were (Obeidu, Ivue, Eror, Egbele, Obiyon and Efandion). The sensitizations in the six communities were massively attended by community members who were made up of men, women and children. Before the film show in each of the communities, the Director Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo made remarks in which he emphatically condemned the practice of celebrating wealth without finding out the source. He stated many instances where parents sold lands, borrowed money to send their children abroad, others comparing their children with people they do not know their source of wealth. He further stated that many youth from record lost their lives via this process of irregular migration, some sold their organs while many are involve in inglorious activities. He therefore at



Barr. Onomen addressing the community members in Ivue

this point defined human trafficking as an illegal and irregular trade which reduces human to mere commodity. He therefore encouraged parents and youths to desist from the act.

Barrister Oriakhi Onomen who represented Catholic Caritas Foundation of Nigeria (CCFN) noted that Human trafficking has become an issue of concern especially in our community where young children are no longer interested in education or learning a trade but focusing their interest on the latest car and building without hard work, as a result many especially the females are trafficked for sex work in Europe while the male are introduced to yahoo and other inglorious business.



Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo addressing the gathering in Egbele community during the sensitization and film show

Following this brief introduction, the participants with key interest sat and watched the film which described how a young girl was taken from her community by a supposed aunty in disguise to sponsor her education in the city. This brought happiness to her parents who willingly allow the woman to take their daughter to city but on arriving the city, she unveil her aim and turned the girl into a slave in her house. The little child was maltreated, beaten and denied of many basic needs including education and

eventually beaten one day to a point that the neighbour invited the Police who arrested the perpetrator and eventually led to her liberation and unification to her

family. Most of the participants particularly the women could not hold themselves seeing how the little girl was beaten and maltreated. They vowed that their children will not be victims of such but to train their children with the little they can provide.

Onomen further explained that human traffickers treat human beings like commodity and deny them of respect and dignity. She also advised the participants not to be lured by the beautiful houses and cars that some of these individuals who have returned from abroad display, making it seem like it is so easy to earn money abroad. She stated that the most of



A community leader making a contribution in Efandion

those who have returned with so much money within a short period of time cannot justify their source of wealth. She

also added that anyone having it in mind to travel abroad should do so legally following the safe migration tips and that even in Europe things are not as easy as they have to



Participants watching the film show at Efandion

work very hard to earn money.

Another documentary titled '*journey to hell*' was shown to the audience. There were reactions of empathy, disgust and pain on some of the visuals by everyone present.

After the brief film, some of the elders in the communities expressed their gratitude to UROMI JDPCI, CCFN and the Catholic Church for the sensitization and promised to tell members of their household as well as discuss the issues in their community meetings.

In conclusion, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo thanked participants from the various communities and re-emphasized the need for the message of the ills of human trafficking to be taken to all nooks and crannies of the communities in Esan North East Local Government Area.

SENSITIZATION AT THE UROMI MOTOR PARK

Uromi JDPCI Anti human trafficking project team was at the Uromi Central Motor Park to create awareness and sensitize the people on the dangers of irregular migration and human



Some persons watching the documentary on anti-human trafficking

trafficking, an ugly trend among the youth in Uromi. The team led by the Director Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo accompanied by Barr. Onomen Oriakhi of the Catholic



Some persons watching the documentary on anti-human trafficking

Caritas Foundation of Nigeria adopted film

show as a method to sensitize the people. The Chairman of the Motor Park graciously made a space available in one of the garage to set up the projector for the film show. Members of the project team and volunteers went round the park to invite people to the venue of the sensitization. The team then began with projection and



Fr. Fidelis addressing the people while Onomen is working on the film show

presentation of the films which was also explained to the people in local language. One of the films was on the *journey to hell* a documentary on the journey of irregular migrants through the Sahara desert and the Mediterranean Sea



Some volunteers at the Motor Park inviting people to the stand for film show and sensitization

all in the bid to travel abroad. The film revealed the horror, trauma

and pains experienced by the migrants who also narrated their experiences during the interview in the documentary. This left the people in self-pity as they expressed sympathy towards the victims. Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo and Barr. Onomen used the occasion to encourage the people to desist from irregular migration as well as advise their friends and relatives based on what they have seen. The drivers were admonished to be promoters of safe migration by the virtue of the fact that they travel all routes and carry some of these people and hear their discussions and plans to engage in irregular migration.

The participants appreciated the team for the visual presentation which has awoken in them the sense of reality of the ugly situation and promised to lend their voice to promote safe migration and discourage irregular migration and trafficking.

MARKET RALLY CONDUCTED BY UROMI JDPCI IN UROMI MARKET

Similarly, Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives of the Catholic Diocese of Uromi conducted a market rally which was used to sensitize the market women and men on the inherent risks of being trafficked to Europe and other foreign countries and the consequence it has on the family left behind. The key message of the rally was ***Say no to Human Trafficking and Irregular Migration***. The rally held on the 29th of August 2018 had in attendance the Director of Uromi JDPCI Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo, the anti human trafficking desk officer for CCFN Barr. Onomen Oriakhi, Staff of Uromi JDPCI, Community Watch Groups and volunteers of Uromi JDPCI.



Director addressing the people at Uromi market



Another scene at Uromi market during rally

The rally commenced from St Anthony Catholic Cathedral and progressed through the major road down to Uromi market with commentary on the dangers of irregular migration and how some of them were deceived into the act by their

supposed relatives and



Some volunteers with the Director at the market

closed ones. Placards (with inscriptions discouraging trafficking and irregular migration) and handbills were also displayed and some shared out to the market women. This was necessary to

educate and inform the people of the dangers of sending their wards especially their girl child to the perilous journey into human trafficking through irregular migration. Some staff and volunteers took handbills and posters into the various shops and stands in the market to sensitize traders who could not leave their wears to join the team at the center of the market

Barr Onomen Oriakhi who represented the Catholic Caritas Foundation of Nigeria took time to explain to the market women the dangers of irregular migration and the importance of safe migration. She challenged them to asked those who have returned with so much money in their community the type of work they did in abroad to earn the money they have and see if such



Some participants displaying banner and placards with various inscriptions discouraging human trafficking

persons will tell them the truth or identify any legitimate business they did to earn money. As the women gathered round the rally train Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo the Director of Uromi JDPCI urged them to beware of persons who come to them requesting to take their children abroad or to the city for school or job opportunities. He said traffickers indulge in deception to lure their victims. Those who migrate through irregular means sometimes end up in the hands of traffickers who exploit their vulnerability and ignorance or enslave them in debt bondage. He noted that poverty and economic hardship should not be excuses for parents to sacrifice their children to traffickers through irregular migration. Fr. Fidelis encouraged those who want to travel

abroad to follow the right ways as highlighted in the tips to safe migration which was in the handbills shared and read out to the people.

Some of the women who spoke to the team expressed regret over the unfortunate situation, describing the frenzy with which people seek wealth and materialism as shameful and immoral.

SENSITIZATION IN CHURCHES

Uromi Justice Development Peace /Caritas Initiatives in her determination to reduce human trafficking in Esan North East Local Government area of Edo State, dispatched different teams to different churches in Esan North East Local Government Area to campaign against human trafficking and raise awareness on safe migration. The team carried out sensitization in five churches (St John The Evangelist Catholic Church, Ivue, Our Lady of Lourdes, Idigun, St. Patrick, Ebhoiyi, Church of God of Prophecy, Egbele and Redeem Christian Church of God) all in Uromi town on the 9th, 16th and 30th of September, 2018. The sensitizations in the said venues were during their days of worship in which participants made up of men, women and youth enthusiastically listened to the message on



A cross section of the congregation at Church of God of Prophecy, Uromi

the dangers of human trafficking and safe migration tips.

The message on human trafficking as well as the dangers inherent in it were enumerated and explained to the congregation at the various churches visited. Human Trafficking was described an evil act that unfortunately seems to be very attractive and drawing many followers among the young people especially those who want to make it by all means. Human trafficking has become an

issue of concern especially in our community where young children are not ready to go to school or learn a trade but would rather focus their interest on the latest car and building without hard work. This unfortunate desire has continued to spread the quest for irregular migration and human trafficking in the community.

In some of the visits some Lybia returnees were brought in by Uromi JDPCI to share their experiences as a way of discouraging others from engaging in irregular migration. They narrated their ordeals on the way to Lybia, and stated that the journey was not palatable like they expected. According to them, many died of starvation and hunger on the way and those that eventually succeeded were imprisoned by some persons who posed as Lybia soldiers. They gave various instances where parents were asked to send money to rescue their children on their way to Lybia, this they said led to the death of many whose parents could not afford the said amount. Parents were therefore admonished to desist from the act of selling their properties to send their children abroad via this irregular means. They were encouraged to send their children to school or allow them to learn trade to earn them a better and brighter future and that if they must travel, it should be for something good and profitable to the society by following a genuine route.

Parents and youth present were therefore counselled to watch out for traffickers who deceive people with unrealistic promising future as well as caution their children to desist from acts and desires that lure them to trafficker and irregular migration.

Bishop Anthony Okosun of the Church of God of Prophecy thanked the team for coming to his Church, he also mentioned some of the interventions carried out by Uromi JDPCI within the local government to keep youth from travelling abroad and join his voice with the speaker to warn his members on the dangers of irregular migration while identifying one of the returnees from one of his branches at Idumonza-Uromi who came with the team. He stated that he was fresher and better here before he travelled to Lybia but thanked God he came back alive to tell the story of his ordeals. The Bishop however promised to invite the team for a full day program to sensitize the church through film show.



A cross section of the congregation at Redeemed Christian Church of God, Uromi



A cross section of the congregation at St John Catholic Church, Ivue

Priests and Pastors in the other Churches visited also commended the effort of Uromi JDPCI and admonished their members to listen to good and godly counsel so as to save the future of their children and the society.

SENSITIZATION AT UROMI CENTRAL MOSQUE:

Uromi Justice Development Peace/Caritas Initiatives was also at Uromi Central Mosque to carry out sensitization. On arrival at the mosque, the Muslim faithful with keen interest listened to the message on the dangers of human trafficking and tips for safe migration. Stories on how young men suffer and die in the desert were told as well as young girls who were trafficked for sexual

exploitation. They were counselled to be contented with whatever Allah has blessed them with, children should be sent to school or allow to learn trade instead of selling lands and houses for them to go abroad uninvited. At the end of the message, the Chief Imam thanked the team for coming and requested for another day to talk more on it with videos on the said issues.



Uromi JDPCI staff addressing Muslim faithfuls at Uromi Central Mosque

FORMATION AND INAUGURATION OF COMMUNITY WATCH GROUPS

To sustain the campaign against human trafficking and safe migration in Esan North East Local Government Area, Uromi JDPCI formed, inaugurated and trained 25 persons as Community Watch Group in five communities. The purpose was to promote community safety net, referral and protection for young against human trafficking. The formation, inauguration and training of the Community Watch Group was anchored by Barr. Onomen Oriakhi and Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo who gave the participants (Volunteers) an overview of the project and trafficking in general.



Barrister Onome facilitating a session

They noted that human trafficking is a form of irregular and illegal trade which reduce human being to mere commodity.

Earlier in the opening remark the Director noted that the community watch group is to serve the purpose of reporting any illegal movement in the community, track the move by parents or caregivers to send their children abroad via illegal route. Additionally, he brought to their



Director giving his opening remark

notice the recent abolishment of the effect of oath by the Oba of Benin. This oath serves as threat to the victim hence many found it difficult to reveal the truth about trafficking and continue to pay until the satisfaction of the trafficker.

The participants expressed readiness and willingness to take up the task of being community watch groups in their various communities

The Director appreciated and admonished them to take the work seriously since they were working for mankind and God will certainly reward them accordingly.

SUSTAINABLE MECHANISM FOR IMPROVING LIVELIHOOD AND HOUSEHOLD EMPOWERMENT (SMILE) PROJECT

Uromi JDPCI conducted activities that were geared towards the provision of quality need based services to enrolled VC and their households. Some of these services were rendered during home visits to households, such as nutritional counselling and growth monitoring while some others



Caregivers' forum in Eror community

such as kids' club and care givers' forum were held in open places within the communities. This quarter also saw the conclusion of another phase of the Adolescent Girls intervention in Egbele community.

Uromi JDPCI conducted some outreaches and campaigns to create access to HIV services in the various communities and ensure that beneficiaries know their HIV status. This quarter

also saw the continuous use of HIV risk assessment tool to help track those who have not known their status within the last six months. Some community dialogues were also conducted to reduce stigma and discrimination as well as outreaches for health education to promote healthy living in the project communities. The SMILE project was officially concluded in this quarter.

HIV PREVENTION, CARE AND SUPPORT

Escort Services

Escort/accompaniment services were rendered to eight (8) positive beneficiaries (4 OVCs, 1 male, 3 female and 4 caregivers, 1 male, 3 female). Uromi JDPCI escorted these beneficiaries to the facility to facilitate access drugs and viral load testing so as to ascertain their level of viral load suppression.

Uromi JDPCI conducted 19 supportive supervision visits to PLHIV in this quarter. The purpose was promote counselling and ensure drug adherence. These visits yielded much fruits as 4 PLHIV (2 OVC and 2



Care and Support Officer during community dialogue

Caregivers) beneficiaries who had defaulted in their treatment due to some erroneous religious beliefs and feeling of wellness have resumed their treatment.

Community Dialogues

As part of effort to reduces HIV stigma and discrimination, Uromi JDPCI also engaged in community dialogue in 8 communities (Ivue, Obeidu, Obiyon-Idigun, Egbele, Obiyon-Awo, Ebhoiyi and Error) with a total number of 101 participants (66 male and 35 female) comprising of community heads, community elders, women leaders and other members of the communities in attendance.

PSYCHOSOCIAL SUPPORT

Uromi JDPCI through the Community volunteers was involved in the provision of Psychosocial Support services to VC and caregivers (4401 beneficiaries comprising 1535 males and 2868 females) through home visits and Kids/youth club, and caregivers' forum which was organized in all project communities.

Kids' Club

As part of the effort to provide psychosocial support to vulnerable children and their household in SMILE project communities Uromi JDPCI conducted 24 Kids/youth club in eight communities(Obeidu, Ivue, Error, Egbele,Onewa, Obiyon, Efandion and Ebhoiyi) of intervention. Kids' club activities were done alongside the youth club in some of these communities for children under the age bracket 6-9 years. The topics covered were



Kids' club session in Ivue community

“Revealing the Hero”. This was to also help the children to build strong psychosocial support among themselves and also learn to work and trust their peers and parent whenever they were faced with difficulty in life. A total of 808 children made up of 390 male and 418 female in attendance.

Care givers forum

In this quarter the women demonstrated great enthusiasm towards the activities as they usually comes out in large numbers to attend the forum. They were engaged in active interactive session using the various topics that apply for each month. In some areas that required role play, the women were grouped to participate in such activity which motivated them even the more to attend the next forum. At the end of each fora, the women were given home work that involved applying what they have learnt in their various homes. A total of 18 fora were conducted in this quarter with 407 persons made up of 6 male and 401 female in attendance.

Adolescent Girls Pilot Intervention



Adolescent girls session in Egbele community

Uromi JDPCI concluded the third phase of Adolescent club intervention in Egbele community. 14 sessions were held within this quarter



The Program Manager addressing adolescent girls and their caregivers during their graduation ceremony

from the topic “The power of effective Communication to setting my Goal”. These various topics were discussed with the girls to help them get full information on sexual and reproductive health messages and how they can become responsible to themselves, their parents, and their community at large.

A total of 60 adolescent girls were reached with HIV and sexual reproductive health messages

HOUSEHOLD ECONOMIC STRENGTHENING SERVICES

Cash Transfer

In this quarter under review, Uromi JDPCI played host to the SMILE HES Technical team which was made up of Felix Ikyereve and Samuel Adotse who came to conduct validation for the



A section of beneficiaries during cash transfer validation

selected beneficiaries for cash transfer. Mr Felix who led the team urged the beneficiaries to be orderly so as to have a smooth and hitch free exercise. Two staff from Uromi JDPCI and volunteers also supported the process. At the end of the exercise which lasted for 3 days 358 persons were validated to benefit from cash transfer. These person eventually got cash transfer of twenty thousand naira (NGN20,000) each from

Uromi JDPCI through the SMILE project

Agricultural Input

In a bid to improve the livelihood of care givers, Uromi JDPCI through SMILE project distributed improved Coconut, oil palm and mango seedlings to care givers who were registered in the SMILE project. The distribution was done across eight communities namely, Egbele, Eror, Efandion, Obiyon, Ivue, Obiedu, Onewa and Ebhoiyi. A total of 260 (two hundred and sixty) (88



The HES Officer addressing Some beneficiaries of the Agricultural tree crops

male and 172 female) caregivers benefited from the distribution of the tree crops in which each beneficiary got three of each of the tree crops.

NUTRITION AND FOOD SECURITY SERVICES

During this reporting period, Uromi JDPCI provided services on Nutrition to a total of 1162 (365 male & 797 females) beneficiaries. Services provided ranged from nutrition education and counselling, growth monitoring, IYCF and food demonstration.

Growth Monitoring

Regular growth monitoring was carried out in the 8 communities using anthropometric measurements (weight, MUAC and height). All of the children accessed were observed to be growing well based on the measurement and the caregivers were commended. A total of 681 (328 males and

353 females) children were reached



Growth monitoring

Infant and Young Child Feeding Support Group:

Promoting and supporting good IYCF practices is a key to preventing malnutrition. Children up to 2 years old are particularly vulnerable hence, the group is made of lactating mothers, pregnant women, elderly mothers, young girls and men. The elderly women present at the meetings encouraged the younger ones on the nutritional benefits of breastfeeding while those that started the meeting early discouraged other members on the dangers of mixed feeding during the first six months of life. A total of 17 meetings were held with 250 caregivers (9 males and 241 females)

Nutrition Education and Counselling:

The Nutrition key Message booklet was used to discuss the importance of Nutrition for the whole household. Caregivers were counselled based on the food present in the community, emphasizing that good food is the best investment which they can make for their household. Special emphases were on the pregnant women, lactating mothers and children because of nutritional needs.

In addition, caregivers were educated on the importance of home garden as a source of fresh and natural food. Some of the crops agreed by the caregivers to plant in their garden during

planting season were okra, maize, green leaf, garden egg, pumpkin and water melon. 231 caregivers (28 males and 185



A volunteer facilitating C-IYCF in Ivue community

females) were reached.

World Breastfeeding Week

As part of the activities to mark this year's breastfeeding week, Uromi JDPCI organized a seminar for caregivers in Eror and Obiyon communities in Esan North East local government area of Edo state on the 2nd and 3rd of August;2018. During the event the importance of breastfeeding was emphasized with discussions centered on

- Exclusive breastfeeding and its importance
- Complementary feeding and its importance
- Signs of good attachment to breast
- Signs of effective sucking
- Signs of hunger

At the end a total of 111 persons (3male and 108 females) were reached in the two communities

PRISON APOSTOLATE

Uromi JDPCI prison apostolate desk as part of her effort at providing support to indigent inmates and to improve their wellbeing and livelihood opportunity by engaging them in activities that can enhance their survival skills after their release from prison, sourced the support of a friend of the organization to train the inmates on basic computer skills.

This was part of the effort to support the utilization of the skill acquisition center donated to the prison by the Catholic Diocese of Uromi through Uromi JDPCI.



A cross section of participants at the HTC services at the prison

Uromi JDPCI also visited the prison to conduct health education and HIV counselling and screening for Prison officials and inmates. The inmates were first taken through some sensitization on the mode of transmission and prevention of HIV as well as the distinction between HIV AND AIDS.

The health officer went further counsel inmates on the need for regular screening and its importance for healthy living. Early discovery and adherence to drug were good ways of putting the disease under control. After the sensitization



HTC services at the prison

exercise, the trained testers invited those who were interested to come forward for the test. Both the prison officials and inmates participated in the screening exercise, at the end of the exercise a total of 110 persons (108 male and 2 female) were screened for HIV/AIDS virus.

MICRO CREDIT

Uromi JDPCI established the micro-credit desk for the purpose of empowering people through soft loans. The soft loan is given to groups which comprises of active poor women and farmers in the society. The scheme is open to Catholics and Non-Catholics within the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District being the coverage area of the Catholic Diocese of Uromi. To qualify you only need to belong to a self-selected group of traders or farmers who desire to improve their activities.



Micro Credit staff with beneficiary in a farm in Obeidu

The scheme is currently being operated in four (4) platforms namely: Micro-Credit (Group), PROMIC I, PROMIC II and AGRIC PROMIC (for farmers only) and a total of seven hundred and ninety five (795) persons are currently benefiting from these schemes.



Cross section of beneficiaries during formation and training

Before any group is given micro credit by Uromi JDPCI, the group is taken through a process of orientation and training on Micro Credit Scheme, importance of savings, methods of repayment, sizes of loan, penalty, registration and confirmation of account numbers. Every form of business, trade and farm quoted by a beneficiary must be

verifiable.